



Czar Ivan III, "Ivan the Great," declared Moscow free of Tartar domination by tearing up the deed (money demand) of Tartar Khan.

APPLY NAMED "THE SPIDER KING,"

Louis XI acceded the French throne in July 1461, marking a critical point in the evolution of the French state. The medieval monarchs of France, whatever their nominal power, were **heavily limited in their influence**. They exercised direct rule over only a limited area, chiefly in the north and center, with the rest of the country controlled by a series of mostly hostile magnates, of whom the **Duke of Burgundy** (Charles the Bold) in 1461 was the most obviously threatening (see 1472–76). By the end of the Hundred Years' War in 1453,



Louis XI
Crowned king of France in 1461, Louis XI extended his rule over an increasing number of territories during his 22-year reign.

France was effectively also bankrupt. Yet by 1481, Louis had not only seen off the last of the dukes of Burgundy, bringing **Artois, Picardy, and Burgundy** itself under his rule, but by a combination of inheritance and clever diplomacy had added **Roussillon, Cerdagne, Maine, Provence, and Anjou**. This extension of centralizing **royal authority** was a crucial step in the subsequent emergence of a unified, much more powerful French state. In reality, relations between the French monarchy and its most powerful subjects would remain fraught well into the 17th century. As elsewhere, it proved necessary both to assert authority and to negotiate with provincial and noble elites. This dual process, central to the making of **early modern France**, led to friction and tension long after the reign of Louis XI.

Expansion on an even more dramatic scale also marked developments in **Muscovy**—the Grand Duchy of Moscow—with the accession of **Ivan III "the Great"** in **March 1462**. The collapse of Mongol rule over the 14th and 15th centuries, and the fall of **Constantinople** (now Istanbul) in 1453, had opened the way for Muscovy not merely to assert leadership of the Orthodox world, but to defy any last Mongol attempts at overlordship. In the process, it sparked a burst of expansion that characterized **Russia** well into the 19th century.

The most notable of these extensions under Ivan was in the

vast **Novgorod Territory**, which, although sparsely populated, economically marginal, and imperfectly known, was rich in natural resources. In 1478, Ivan simply annexed it.

However much it may have increased the stability and prosperity of China, the **Ming dynasty** faced a series of substantial internal threats to its authority as well as continuing conflict with the **Mongols** to the north. If most revolts were the product of famine, a number were also the result of the increasingly autocratic and rigid nature of **Ming rule**. In every case, they were harshly suppressed. In 1464, the same year that the 16-year-old **Emperor Chenghua** came to the throne, such a revolt broke out among the native **Miao and Yao people** in the provinces of Huguang and then Guangxi in south-central China. The revolt took two years to put down. In addition to the **160,000 troops** stationed in the south, a further 30,000 were sent to the two provinces. No accurate estimate of the death toll is possible. The revolt flared up again in 1467 and, on a larger scale, in 1475.

silk binding
covers handle

scabbard



Malbork Castle was the headquarters of the Teutonic Knights. It was Europe's largest medieval brick castle and is in what is now Poland.

THE THIRTEEN YEARS' WAR

between Poland–Lithuania and the **Teutonic Knights**—a military order founded in Palestine—ended with the **Second Treaty of Torun** in 1466. The Teutonic Knights, powerful since the early 13th century (see 1236–40), were

The underlying political fragility of **Japan** and the relative impotence of the **Ashikaga shoguns**, rulers of Japan since 1333, was made starkly clear by the **11-year Onin War**, which broke out in 1467. It left Japan devastated and led to more than

“THE CAPITAL THAT WE BELIEVED WOULD **FLOURISH** FOR **TEN THOUSAND** YEARS HAS NOW BECOME A **LAIR** FOR THE WOLVES.”

Onin Ki, late 15th–mid 16th century account of the Onin War

obliged to cede much of the western half of their territory to **Prussia**, and, in return for Polish–Lithuanian aid in the war, this territory became the property of the Polish crown.

Samurai sword

This 15th-century katana, with its scabbard, is typical of those used in the Onin war. It could deliver a sweeping cut in a single movement.

a century of turbulence—the *Sengoku jidai* or **Warring States Period**—as a series of regional magnates or *daimyo* attempted to eradicate their rivals. The war began as a succession dispute over who would replace the elderly and retiring **Ashikaga Yoshimasa** as shogun, the Hosokawa clan supporting the claims of Yoshimasa's brother, the Yamana clan those of his

March 4, 1461
Henry VI deposed following Battle of Tewkesbury; Edward IV becomes Yorkist king

July 22, 1461
Louis XI becomes king of France

March 1462 Ivan the Great (Ivan III) becomes Grand Duke of Moscow

August 15, 1461
Ottomans take Trebizond

1463 Ottomans conquer Bosnia

1464 Revolts break out across Ming China (to 1468)

1465 Songhai ruler Sunni Ali begins raids on Mali, enlarging the Songhai Empire

1465 League of the Common Weal set up as an aristocratic opposition to Louis XI

October 9, 1466 Second Treaty of Torun, Prussia becomes a fief of Poland

1467 Charles the Bold succeeds Philip the Good to become last Duke of Burgundy

1467 Onin War begins in Japan, initiating the Warring States period (to 1477)

1468 Ottomans take Karaman in south-central Turkey